

Matthew Mettler

Ph.D. Candidate in Political Science
University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign
mettler3@illinois.edu • matthewmettler.github.io

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign *Expected 2027*
Dissertation: Fact–Opinion Differentiation Among Citizens: The Role of Partisan Identity, Cognitive Resources, and Media Cues
Committee: Jeffery Mondak (Chair), Damarys Canache, Brian Gaines, and Thomas Rudolph

M.A. in International Relations, University of South Dakota 2019

B.S. in Political Science, South Dakota State University 2013

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary Fields: American Politics; Political Methodology

Substantive Interests: Misinformation; partisan judgment; political communication; institutional trust; representation; policy feedback; democratic accountability

Methods: Survey research; experimental methods; measurement; causal inference; applied statistical analysis

PUBLICATIONS

Book

Hibbing, M. V., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Raynal, I. R. (forthcoming, 2027). *Misunderstanding the Other Side: How Americans Explain Opposing Views*. Temple University Press.

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Peffley, M. (2026). Experiential spillover in public views of police and courts. *Journal of Law and Courts*. [Article]

Canache, D., Knoll, N. J., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Indigenous quotas and symbolic representation in Latin America. *Journal of Politics in Latin America*. [Article]

McClinton, K. S., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Conceptualizing and measuring structural overlap in the political attitudes and orientations of multidimensional groups. *Social Science Quarterly*, 106(3). [Article]

Pagán Márquez, A. S., Djupe, P. A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Was there an enthusiasm gap? Examining support for Donald Trump among evangelicals and nonevangelicals. *Politics & Religion*, 17(3), 410–430. [Article]

Mettler, M., & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Fact–opinion differentiation. *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review*, 5(2). [Article]

JOB MARKET PAPER

Mettler, M. Accuracy, Bias, or Noise in Political Judgments? A Compositional Approach to Fact–Opinion Classification.

MANUSCRIPTS

Revise and Resubmit

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Guardrails, Accomplices, or Bystanders? Citizen Response to Undemocratic Elite Cues. *Revise and resubmit at Democratization*.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Three Tests of the Political Impact of Individual-Level Variation in the Negativity Bias. *Revise and resubmit at the Journal of Experimental Political Science*.

Under Review

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Strojny, L. M. There but for Misfortune: The Impact of Economic Information and Misinformation on Voting in the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election. *Under review*.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. A Targeted Strategy for Improving the Mass Public’s Capacity to Identify True and False Political Claims. *Under review*.

Working Papers

Mettler, M. Nudging Away from Bias: Accuracy Prompts and Partisan Fact–Opinion Classification.

Mettler, M. Facts by Association: How Media Cues Shape Political Classification.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. A Multidimensional Approach to Measuring Misinformation Response Tendencies.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Creating Measures of Retrospective Perceptions beyond Economic Indicators.

Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.** Moral Tradeoffs in Candidate Choice: When Do Evangelical Voters Excuse Misconduct?

POLICY REPORTS AND PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Eviction expectations in the aftermath of the pandemic moratoria. *University of Illinois College of Law Legal Studies Research Paper*, No. 24-06. [Article]

- Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Texas's movement to online court is sensible, but more study should follow. *Voice for the Defense*, 20–22. [Article]
- Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs Policy Spotlight*. [Article]
- Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Courts and the housing market. *News-Gazette*. [Article]
- Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, Wilson, R. F., & Miller, A. (2022). The impact of COVID-19 on state court proceedings: Five key findings. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs Policy Spotlight*. [Article]

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). The political impact of individual-level variation in the negativity bias. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Newcastle, United Kingdom.
- Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). Economic realities, partisan fictions: Facts, perceptions, and partisan bias in economic voting. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.
- Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Peffley, M. (2025). Experiential spillover in public views of police and courts. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada.
- Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Elite cues can induce the erosion of democratic support: Evidence from two U.S. surveys. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Prague, Czech Republic.
- Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Fostering political lie detection. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.
- Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Measuring and modeling misinformation: A strategy for assessing the relative prevalence of partisan and residual error. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.
- Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.** (2025). When to tolerate immorality by elected officials and when not to. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.
- Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Elite cues and Americans' support for authoritarian world leaders. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Southern Political Science Association, San Juan, Puerto Rico.
- Canache, D., Knoll, N. J., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Indigenous quotas and perceived representation in Latin America. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the European Political Science Association, Cologne, Germany.

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. Paper presented at the Race and Social Justice Symposium, Champaign, Illinois.

TEACHING AND MENTORING

Instructor of Record

The U.S. Supreme Court	Summer 2026
Politics and the Media	Fall 2025
Introduction to American Politics	Spring 2025
Introduction to Politics	Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant

State Government in the United States	Fall 2026
Introduction to International Relations	Spring 2026
Strategic International Relations	Spring 2024
Junior Honors Thesis	Fall 2023
Introduction to Political Behavior	Fall 2023

Graduate Methods Instruction

Political Science Math Camp: Probability and R Programming	2025
Political Science Math Camp: Probability and R Programming	2024
Political Science Math Camp: Linear Regression and R Programming	2023

Undergraduate Research Mentoring

Josh Ellison	2026
<i>Challenging the Partisan Voter: A Two-Dimensional Model of Vote Choice beyond Ideology</i>	
Nathan Knoll	2025
<i>Effects of Legislative Gender Quotas on Political Efficacy</i>	
Vindhya Kalipi	2024
<i>I'm Just a Bill: The Impact of Civic Education on Democratic Engagement</i>	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Institute of Government and Public Affairs

2021–2022

- Collaborated with a team of scholars investigating the effects of COVID-19 on state court systems.
- Prepared policy reports for publication through the Institute’s Access to Justice Initiative.
- Conducted in-depth interviews with court officials for policy research projects.

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Dissertation Completion Fellowship (\$12,000), University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign

2026

MPSA Travel Grant, Department of Political Science

2025, 2026

List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign

2025, 2026

Summer Dissertation Fellowship (\$3,000), Department of Political Science

2025

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer

Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review

2026

Departmental Service

Faculty Search Committee, Graduate Representative

2024

Political Science Math Camp Committee

2023–2025

MEDIA AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

The 21st Show, Illinois Public Media

2024

WTAX, Illinois statewide radio

2023

WCIA-TV, Champaign, Illinois

2023

CBS Chicago Morning Show

2023

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association

International Society of Political Psychology

Midwest Political Science Association